AN INTEGRATED SAFETY NET

Kishori Vikasam's strength lies in its convergence architecture.

Schools provide the principal platform for reaching adolescents, with sessions covering education, attendance, life skills, health, hygiene, child rights and digital safety. Career guidance links students to higher education, ITIs, polytechnics, vocational education, scholarships and skill programmes.

At the community level, SERP brings the SHG ecosystem into the programme, mobilising families and communities around girls' education, health, nutrition, child marriage prevention, cyber safety and career opportunities. SHGs and Village Organisations are also positioned as community-level partners in preventing child marriage and supporting vulnerable adolescents.

APSSDC adds another important dimension—career preparedness. Adolescents are introduced to vocational courses, technical training, digital and employability skills, entrepreneurship and industry-oriented opportunities, with encouragement for girls to enter technical and non-traditional sectors.

At the last mile, Gram/Ward Sachivalayam functions as a bridge between adolescents, families and government services, helping identify vulnerable and out-of-school adolescents and connecting them with education, health, welfare, counselling, skills and protection services.

TAKING EMPOWERMENT TO SCALE

The programme has already created a substantial field-level network. 275 master trainers and 2,700 district master trainers have been developed. More than 75,000 village-level members have been trained, while 43,500 adolescent groups involving over 4.15 lakh adolescent girls have been formed in vulnerable communities. Institutional coverage extends to 14,305 government and private schools.









The Kishori Vikasam Summer Campaigns of 2025 and 2026 further expanded outreach. The campaigns covered 9.57 lakh adolescent girls, while 3.77 lakh adolescent boys were covered in 2026. During the 2025-26 academic year, adolescent empowerment activities in high schools and junior colleges reached 29.16 lakh children.

The sessions themselves are designed to be practical, covering menstrual hygiene, reproductive health, child rights, anaemia, gender equality, education and careers, cybersecurity, financial management, leadership, physical activity and child-marriage prevention.

Partnerships are strengthening the programme further. UNICEF has supported learning resources, IEC materials and structured modules covering health, education, protection, life skills, career guidance and cyber safety. Padala Charitable Trust has supported regional workshops and dedicated learning material for adolescent boys through YUVA groups.

BEYOND WELFARE, TOWARDS INDEPENDENCE

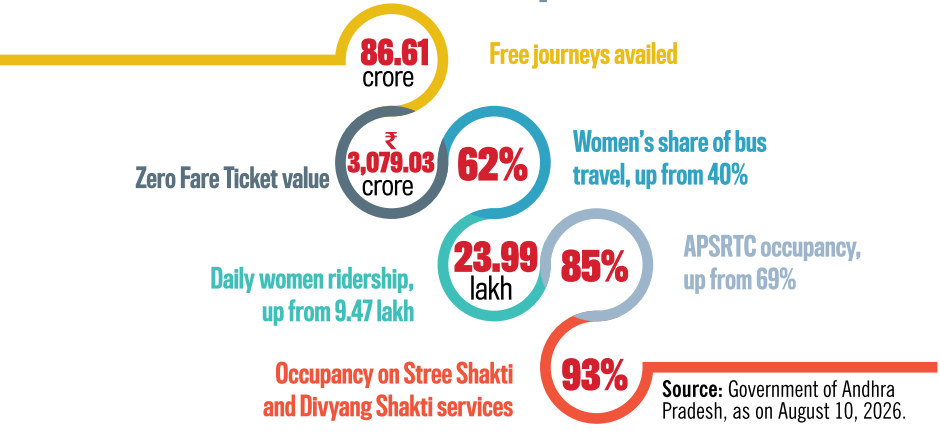
The significance of these initiatives lies in their cumulative impact. A woman who can travel without the burden of a daily transport fare has greater freedom to access work, education, healthcare and public services. A girl who understands her rights, manages her finances, knows where to seek help, develops digital awareness and receives career guidance enters adulthood with a stronger foundation for independence.

That is the larger story emerging from Andhra Pradesh's women-centric interventions: empowerment is being approached not as a single scheme, but as a continuum of opportunity, capability, safety and choice.

Stree Shakti expands mobility today. Kishori Vikasam builds confidence and capability for tomorrow. Together, they point towards a model in which the state's investment in women is measured not only by benefits delivered, but by the opportunities women and girls are enabled to pursue.

The ambition is ultimately simple—and transformative: to make mobility, knowledge, safety, skills and opportunity essential building blocks of every woman's journey towards greater independence.

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Source: Government of Andhra Pradesh, as on August 10, 2026.